

STAGE SIXTEEN • WORKPLACE PROFESSIONALISM & ETHICS

FIRSTS

FAQ

Anticipated participant questions and suggested facilitator responses

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • FAQ

Stage Sixteen • Workplace Professionalism & Workplace Readiness / Professional Ethics & Integrity

PURPOSE

These are the questions that come up most often across cohorts of Stage Sixteen, with a suggested facilitator response for each. Use these as a starting point, not a rigid script.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. What if I don't currently have a workplace to reference for the professionalism FIRSTS?

A: Reference your most recent internship, part-time job, or even a structured academic or volunteer environment — the underlying skills (punctuality, ownership, etiquette) transfer across contexts.

Q2. Do I have to share details of a real ethical dilemma or mistake with the group?

A: No. Several exercises ask you to reflect on or analyze something real and personal, but you're never required to disclose specifics to the group. Facilitators will always tell you clearly when something is opt-in.

Q3. What if I realize during this stage that I haven't been living up to my own stated standards?

A: That's genuinely the point of FIRST T41, and it's a sign the reflection is working, not a failure. Use FIRST T18's approach (Performance Improvement Plan) to turn that honest gap into a specific, trackable plan.

Q4. What if my organization doesn't seem to have clear ethics or speak-up policies?

A: That's useful information to note for FIRST T36 and T42. In the absence of formal channels, a direct conversation with a trusted manager or HR contact is almost always a reasonable starting point.

Q5. How do I know if something is genuinely a conflict of interest (T28) if I'm not sure?

A: When in doubt, disclose it. A disclosed non-issue costs you almost nothing; an undisclosed real conflict can cost genuine trust. Ask your organization's compliance or HR contact if you're genuinely unsure.

Q6. What if I use AI tools regularly and I'm not sure I'm applying T37's ethical practices consistently?

A: Start with one concrete habit: verify factual claims before sharing AI-drafted content, and disclose AI involvement when it's genuinely relevant. Consistency builds from there.